C1 Listening

Following a short lecture

Use the speaker's signposts to follow the structure of an academic talk and take useful notes.

In lectures you cannot reread, so the speaker's signposts are your map. They tell you when a new point starts, when an example is coming and which ideas matter most. Pair this lesson with Signposting in presentations.

The speaker says	What to do in your notes
There are three main reasons...	Number 1, 2, 3 down the page.
The key point here is...	Underline or star it.
For instance... Take the case of...	Write "e.g." and a few words.
However... On the other hand...	Note the contrast with an arrow.
To sum up...	Check your notes match the summary.

Listen

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Today I'd like to look at why some cities are planting more trees. There are three main reasons. The first is temperature. Streets with trees can be several degrees cooler in summer, which matters more and more as heatwaves become common. The second reason is health. For instance, a study in Toronto found that people living on tree-lined streets reported fewer heart problems. The third reason, and this is the key point, is cost. Trees reduce the need for air conditioning and help manage rainwater, so they can save a city money. However, trees are not a quick fix. They take years to grow and need regular care. So, to sum up, urban trees cool the city, improve health and save money, but only with long-term investment.

Prepare the page. When you hear *There are three main reasons*, write 1, 2 and 3 with space after each before the speaker continues.

Common mistake. Writing full sentences. You will miss the next point. Use key words, abbreviations and symbols.

Practice

1. What is the topic of the talk?
2. What are the three reasons the speaker gives?
3. Which reason does the speaker call the key point?
4. What example supports the health reason?
5. Which signpost introduces a problem with the idea?

▼ **Show answers**

1. Why cities are planting more trees
2. Temperature (cooler streets), health, and cost (saving money)
3. Cost
4. A study in Toronto: people on tree-lined streets reported fewer heart problems.
5. *However* (trees are not a quick fix)